

The Red Herring: A Text-Based RPG

I. Problem Statement

People may be seeking to try out something new that is entertaining yet tests their critical thinking skills and rationality. Though the first thing that comes to mind would be puzzle games, common issues in the genre faced by players — both new and old — include but are not limited to logic flaws, such as far-fetched solutions and solutions requiring knowledge outside of the game, mental fatigue, and technical issues.

II. Project Objectives

This project's goals are the following:

- ❖ To provide an immersive experience for all users;
- ❖ To serve as entertainment for all users; and
- ❖ To improve users' critical thinking skills, logical reasoning, and imagination.

III. Planned Features/Functions:

- ❖ Keyboardless/Clickable Options
 - Inventory
 - Map Navigation
 - Narration
- ❖ Multiple Investigations/Cases
- ❖ Vintage/1920s Program Design and Visuals
- ❖ Interactive Characters

IV. Planned Inputs and Outputs

- ❖ Inputs
 - Inventory
 - Map Navigation
 - User's Name
 - Possible Actions
- ❖ Outputs
 - Main Menu
 - Narrative Text
 - Dialogue
 - User Status
 - Feedback Messages
 - Suspect Choices
 - Ending (Winning/Failure Ending)

V. Logic Plan: Pseudocode

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None
START
SHOW main menu
IF user choose PLAY:
    ASK for USER'S NAME
    inventory = empty
    clues = empty
    location_now = starting area

WHILE game is not finished:
    SHOW current location description
    SHOW choosable possible actions:
        Option 1 - Investigate
        Option 2 - Talk
        Option 3 - Move
        Option 4 - Show Inventory

    IF user CHOOSE Option 1:
        SHOW objects
        IF object is important:
            ADD object to clues
            SHOW object message
        ELSE:
            PRINT "Nothing useful here..."

    ELIF user CHOOSE Option 2:
        SHOW dialogue options
        UPDATE story from the user's choice

    ELIF user CHOOSE Option 3:
        SHOW map
        UPDATE current location

    ELIF user CHOOSE Option 4:
        IF inventory empty:
            PRINT "Empty inventory"
        ELSE:
            PRINT inventory

CHECK IF all clues are collected
IF True:
    ASK "Solve Case?"

IF user CHOOSE YES:
    PRESENT suspects
    IF correct:

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        SHOW Victory ending
ELSE:
        SHOW Failure ending
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END
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VI. References / Citations - APA-style or URLs

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